

OREGON CITY COURIER

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MINISTERS TO MEN

"It gives me a pain in the pit of my stomach to have a full grown man, whom I could wallow with one hand tied behind my back without half trying, or whom I could outwork, outrun or outjump, feel that he has to talk to me like he would to some ten-year-old kid, or to some old woman, because he has happened to make the discovery that I try to preach once in a while down at the Baptist church. More men are hypocrites in a preacher's company more times than they are anywhere else. When the Lord called me to preach he called me first of all to be a man. And when I can't be a man with other men I consider it time to get out of the ministry."

"I have never been a confessor. When a man comes to me to tell his misdeeds, I try to get him to tell to God and to leave me out."

"If I have some personal matter with any man I propose to settle it out of the pulpit. If I can settle it with him amicably I endeavor to do so. If one hundred and seventy pounds of Scotch brawn and good nature can't settle an ordinary trouble without calling in the police or the church session, then I'm willing to take my licking like a man, and keep judiciously quiet about it afterwards."

Lo, the millennium has arrived! An Oregon City preacher is guilty—guilty of being a man among men, rather than a saint among sinners or a sinner among saints. Shall we burn him at the stake as a heretic or merely banish him from Rome? When did the Lord take to calling men, real honest 170-pound men to do his gracious work?

Yet, alas and alack, it is true! An Oregon City preacher signs his name to a statement that he can take his "licking" like a man, that he has occasionally a pain in the pit of his stomach just like other mortals.

The preacher who fills his church to overflowing has discarded the frock coat, the flat black hat, the long, sour face and the sacred, aged doctrine that to be a Christian a man must be unworshiped in the extreme. He buttons his collar in front and, perchance, adorns his manly bosom with a pink necktie—if a loving aunt should send it in her Christmas package.

The day of the human religion, Christianity for men and women, is upon us. The frock coated sinner who weekly wailed damnation, hellfire and brimstone is rapidly taking a seat in the rear pews. His old stuff don't touch the modern heart and the modern heart refuses to make the modern head believe that it can.

Instead, glory be, we have that school in the ministry which pounds its sermon notes out on a typewriter, boils its coffee in a percolator and reads Charles Van Loan's horse race stories with the same whole souled delight it feels when it lands a two-pound Rainbow, or exhibits the horns of its last season's deer. Honest to goodness, friends, some of them don't even think "damn" is a swear word, though their gentlemanly modesty usually forbids its use.

It is a school of ministers to men. A school whose pupils will accomplish in a single decade more for Christianity in the name of Christ, as he intended it should be accomplished, than all the hypocritical conglomeration that has graced and disgraced the pulpit in 20 centuries.

A minister who can take his licking like a man—without a whimper—will appeal to men. A minister who will refuse to shield himself from a wallop behind the spectacles of religion will appeal to humanity. He will win human hearts and human minds to the work of the Lord and carry the gleaming standard of manhood's Christianity to the uppermost pinnacle of service.

Business mottoes are supplanting time-worn puritanical traditions in Christianity. Black bow ties are giving away, figuratively, to the pink ones and sectarianism is being replaced by real salvation.

It is better so! To this real Christianity, the Christianity that can take its "licking" manfully and can outwork, outrun and outjump the sins that beset this sad old world, we will open our arms and our hearts and receive it with a joyous welcome for a blessing long delayed.

May the school of ministers to men—human, fighting, fishing, laughing, broad-minded men—put its product into the pulpit of every church in the land, that the churches may be less and the Christians more. Amen!

THE SUNDOWN TRAIL

Perhaps those of us who lived at a time when Buffalo Bill's heroism was prominent in thought for its startling reality, when the Indian tribes of a new nation were but beginning their long ride to the happy hunting ground, when man and beast roamed free in the great west—perhaps we mourn a little more keenly the passing of Buffalo Bill than do those to whom the great plainsman was but the last of the heroes of fiction and history.

Buffalo Bill has journeyed to the end of the sundown trail, whose rugged path he found bravely as he did the trackless prairies of another age, and he rests today beneath the blossom-bower of love that is a tribute to his sterling manhood, to his valor, to his work. He is not dead, the poet says. Buffalo Bill will live for many years in the fiction of the dead west and his symbolic life will be brought back to us occasionally in the historical annals of man's conquest, of heart's truth and mind's mastery.

He rests in peace on the plains that have become populous and highly civilized, the plains whose brushy distances have grown up to humming industry, to tall buildings, to the monuments of man—the plains he helped to conquer, the plains he would not leave until the curtain for the last act of a great epic drama of human life, venturesome, imaginative, creative, had gone up on a scene where orchards, gardens, factories and cheery homes covered the long trails of the Golden West.

Buffalo Bill fought his last big battle—hand to hand with death—with that same brave vigor that he fought in the days when the great divide was opened to him many times by the snapping bullet of an ambushed redskin or the flashing teeth of a mountain brute.

We may forget the man, for in death men are too often out of mind, but forever will remain the monument to his works—the west. It is a fertile little world within itself that owes its very existence to Buffalo Bill and his like. And other generations can do themselves no greater justice nor pay greater respect to the last of the frontiersmen, whose unending day is spent in the cold clay of the prairies he loved so well, than to make his life, from its dawn until the last barrier was down and he stood at the end of the sundown trail, a model for other lives, whose glory may be achieved by clean living and the valor of real manhood.

PROGRESS IN 1916

The unexampled economic progress of this nation during 1916 was reflected in all the traditional barometers that measure the rise and fall of business. With trade and industry booming at record prices, and with speculation in stocks, grain and cotton on a noteworthy scale, bank

clearings naturally made a phenomenal exhibit; the unequalled railroad earnings and the great freight congestion testified to the remarkable volume of traffic handled by the common carriers; ocean transportation was also taxed beyond its capacity and shipbuilding experienced a striking revival, while new construction in other lines participated actively in the forward movement. The demand for skilled labor everywhere largely exceeded the supply, and though the extreme living costs proved burdensome in many quarters, savings deposits were swelled materially with wages at the highest point ever known. Circulation of money showed a progressive increase, reaching its maximum in December, and investors received unparalleled sums in interest and dividends, besides benefitting in the way of large special disbursements.

Without exception, leading manufacturing industries have enjoyed the most prosperous year of their history, says Dun's Review. Long-established branches have undergone a veritable reconstruction, vastly increasing their capacity, and production, though hampered by labor scarcity and wage controversies, as well as by car shortages and paucity of raw materials, largely surpassed all previous records. Yet, in spite of the augmented outputs, supplies were insufficient and much profitable business was rejected, either because of the inability or disinclination of manufacturers to commit themselves further. The most astonishing feature was the magnitude and maintenance of demand, notwithstanding the extraordinary rise of prices. In the rush to cover immediate and far-forward needs the element of cost was of secondary consideration with many buyers and at times some sellers virtually withdrew from the markets in an effort to check the influx of orders which they could not handle, or were not disposed to accept less quotations change to their disadvantage. Industrial and commercial development during 1916 differed from the experience of certain other years, in that consumption more than kept pace with production and thus prevented the accumulation of stocks that resulted disastrously on some former occasions.

THE DEAD WEIGHT

The past year has admittedly been one of the most prosperous for the farmer in recent history. There has been a strong and consistent demand for the products of the farm and prices have been uniformly good. Every productive acre has done its full share toward making profits larger.

But in this period of active markets and good prices, what have the unproductive acres been doing for their owners? What is the record of the swales and the swamps and the lands that are so low and wet that they cannot be worked early enough in the spring to plant a profitable crop? Have they been doing anything to add to the general prosperity? They have not. They have stood idle and useless at the time when they should have been paying for themselves.

The drainage propaganda is no "ism" and is no fine-spun theory. It is a straight business problem that must be solved before the upper Willamette's prosperity is as great as it ought to be. All the land that is lying practically idle because it is not drained ought to be producing good crops. It ought to be an asset to its owners instead of a liability. It ought to be attracting new population instead of frightening away the good farmers who see it and jump to the conclusion that the country is no good. It ought to be changed over from the non-productive to the productive volume.

It cannot be repeated too often that drainage is an investment and not an expense. The man who decides to drain his land is merely putting up a few dollars so that he can get more dollars back. The farmer who has low, wet land and fails to drain it is like the merchant who has a good display and does not use it. Both are neglecting opportunities for profit.—Register.

Obituaries

John Graw

John Graw, for many years a night watchman at the Crown-Willamette mills here, died at his home at Bolton Thursday night, aged 48 years. Mr. Graw is survived by his widow and four children, John, Agnes, Esther and Joseph. He was a native of Iowa.

N. L. Allen

N. L. Allen, aged 63, was buried on Saturday from the Lutheran church at Canby. Mr. Allen died at his home at New Era on Monday, January 8, but the body had been held at the Holman parlors here pending the arrival of a sister from North Dakota. Mr. Allen was a bachelor and a native of Norway. He had been living at New Era for the past 11 years, where he had another sister, Mrs. Meten.

Mrs. Mary Maple

Funeral services for Mrs. Mary E. Maple, who died at the home of her son, William, at Canby Thursday morning, were held from the M. E. church in Oregon City on Saturday morning, the Rev. W. B. Moore of Canby officiating. Interment was in Mountain View. Mrs. Maple was a native of Pennsylvania, where she was born October 22, 1837. She lived in Oregon City until seven years ago, when she moved to Canby. Mr. Maple died here in 1890. Mrs. Maple is survived by four children: George R. Maple, Portland; William, Canby; E. J., Multnomah; and Jennie Butts, Parkplace. The body was at the Holman parlors.

25c Per Month is the Average Cost of Operating a Mitchell Water System

Don't Envy the City Man's Home Make Him Envy Yours!

The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad gauge life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this city was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

THE Mitchell Water System

The MITCHELL SYSTEM enables you

To use as MUCH water as you wish WHEN YOU WISH, to have as MANY faucets as you want WHERE you want them at no extra cost; to regulate your own pressure—as MUCH or as LITTLE as you wish; to use your water for gardening—irrigating—sprinkling or for whatever other purpose you may desire. That's why a MITCHELL WATER SYSTEM gives you the best of the City Man.

The System for the country or suburban home has solved your problem. The time was when you had either to be content with an elevated tank, a constant eyesore, that served warm water in summer or as likely frozen up in winter or do without water pressure entirely.

MR. REYNOLDS of Clackamas, Oregon, has a MITCHELL SYSTEM.



Stover Engines
Myers Pumps
Implement and Vehicles
PORTLAND - OREGON
Spokane Boise

W. J. WILSON & CO., Oregon City Agent

J. S. Yoder

Funeral services for J. S. Yoder, who died at his home at Yoder, were held there on Thursday with the Rev. F. C. Butler of the Congregational church officiating. Six sons were the pallbearers. Mr. Yoder, a native of Missouri, came to Clackamas county in 1889 and had lived on the same farm in the south end of the county ever since, following farming and sawmill occupations. He was known as an active worker in the church and his pride was in service. He is survived by six grown sons and two daughters. Many friends and relatives attended the funeral Thursday and there were many beautiful floral offerings.

TALK RURAL CREDITS

Plan to Put Amendment Into Working Order

Members of the state land board, of the grange and others interested in advancement of rural credits legislation held a meeting at State Treasurer Kay's offices in Salem last week and formulated the plan for legislation desired to place the rural credits amendment in operation as soon as possible. The rules and regulations governing loans under the amendment will be left largely discretionary with the land board, according to the plans outlined.

The legislature will be asked to pass merely the legislation that is specifically pointed out in the amendment, with one addition, suggested by Mr. Kay relative to loans on adjudicated water rights appurtenant to irrigated lands. The amendment, in making it mandatory that the legislative assembly provide legislation relative to the rural credits funds provided that "such safeguards shall include clear definitions of the terms 'occupy' and 'operate' used herein." The legislature is asked to define such terms.

Provision also is asked, in line with Mr. Kay's request, that loans shall be made upon adjudicated water rights appurtenant to irrigated lands up to fifty per cent of their value. This is a question which has caused considerable interest in the eastern Oregon counties and it is understood that the eastern Oregon members are anxious that the provision be contained. Otherwise, it is stated, the question of how loans could be made under the fund on lands of that character would be thrown into considerable confusion.

As the greater share of the irrigated land is of no value without water, a question is presented as to whether any loans whatever might be made on such lands if no specific provision was made relative to the water rights. The outline of the proposed legislation will be turned over to Attorney General Brown to draft a bill and it is probable the bill will be presented to the legislature some time next week.

360 BUSINESS FAILURES

Fly-by-Night Merchants Blamed for Oregon Record. Less Than 1916 Although there is encouragement

E. H. COOPER M. R. COOPER
County Agents
OREGON FIRE RELIEF ASSOCIATION
FARMERS MUTUAL FIRE RELIEF ASSOCIATION
and a number of other good companies
ALSO
AUTOMOBILE, SICK and ACCIDENT INSURANCE
Phones: 366 - 237-J - A-11
Better Call Us Up
The E. H. Cooper Insurance Agency
Established 1902
OREGON CITY, OREGON

CLIMBED STAIRS ON HER HANDS

Too Ill to Walk Upright. Operation Advised. Saved by Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound.

This woman now raises chickens and does manual labor. Read her story: Richmond, Ind.—"For two years I was so sick and weak with troubles from my age that when going up stairs I had to go very slowly with my hands on the steps, then sit down at the top to rest. The doctor said he thought I should have an operation, and my friends thought I would not live to move into our new house. My daughter asked me to try Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound as she had taken it with good results. I did so, my weakness disappeared, I gained in strength, moved into our new home, did all kinds of garden work, shoveled dirt, did building and cement work and raised hundreds of chickens and ducks. I cannot say enough in praise of Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound and if these facts are useful you may publish them for the benefit of other women."—Mrs. M. O. JOHNSTON, Route Box 190, Richmond, Ind.



in the fact that there were less business and commercial failures in Oregon this year than there have been for a number of years, there is still a very startling story to be told about the failures of 1916. No doubt the fact that there were 360 business failures in Oregon in 1916 is due to the inexperience of those who launched enterprises and because of the probable inclusion in these figures of those increasing fly-by-night business men, who locate long enough to dispose of a few shoddy pieces of aged merchandise and move on to greener fields.

In 1916 there were 360 failures in Oregon's business world. During the previous year, 1915, 393 failures were reported. The total assets of business places that failed last year was \$2,391,216, and liabilities were \$4,243,438. Assets averaged \$6642, and liabilities \$10,676. With 393 failures in 1915 the average liability was \$9226. Therefore, although there were fewer failures last year, it is apparent that more money was involved. There was no bank failure in this state in the year just past. In 1916 there were five less failures in Washington than in Oregon, in spite of the fact that in 1915 there were 132 more in Washington than in this state. Of the Oregon business failures 110 were manufacturing enterprises with total liabilities of \$2,698,243; 210 trading businesses with liabilities totalling \$1,206,333 and 31 miscellaneous commercial failures with total liabilities of \$338,862.

On the Pacific coast, Oregon, Washington, California, 2195 business undertakings failed in 1915, as compared with 1845 in 1916, and liabilities were one-third lower this year. The total number of failures in the United States in 1915 was 22,156 and in 1916, 16,993. While there were 133 bank failures in the United States in 1915 there were but 50 in the past year. Of the manufacturing industries which failed within the last five years clothing and millinery manufacturers to the number of 3553 have headed the list. Last year there were 565 failures in this line, compared with 858 in 1915. The liabilities in such firms averaged low, however. Grocery, meat and fish tradesmen failed in greater number last year and within the past five years than any others. There were 3599 such failures last year, bringing the total up to 15,803 for the five year period. The average liability was \$3592.

Do You Know

that Saturday, January 20th 1917 is positively the last day of the big closing out sale at Eddy's store, well it absolutely is and you surely will save money by coming to this sale during the next two final days

COME

Eddy's
DEPENDABLE STORE
526 MAIN - OREGON CITY ORE.

Semi-Tropical Southern California

CALIFORNIA—with its oranges, its Winter flowers, its beaches, its mountain resorts, its time-stained missions, its delightful sunshine and out-of-door life—surely the call is irresistible in January.

But a two days journey away on daily trains of the delightful

SHASTA ROUTE

Shasta Limited
California Express
San Francisco Express

You can secure tickets or complete information from any agent, or write

JOHN M. SCOTT, General Passenger Agent
Portland, Oregon

SOUTHERN PACIFIC LINES

Are You in a Hurry?

If you are a Man in a Hurry, by doing business with this Bank you will have prompt, speedy service. But do not think you have to be in a hurry when you come here. Take your time—we make our time your time—and whether you want a few minutes or many minutes of our time is for you to say.

Some people can transact their Banking business in 60 seconds. Some take 60 minutes. Both our seconds and our minutes are at your command—heartily and cordially.

The Bank of Oregon City

Oldest, Largest and Strongest Bank in Clackamas County